



[BIT703 Web Technologies](#) / [Contents](#) / Topic 6: Client-side web application development – CSS / Understanding CSS

CSS fonts 30m

Fonts are applied to text using the font-family property. Using the font-family property, you specify the font you want to use and a fallback font to use in case the browser can't load the intended font.



[Skip to main content](#)

HTML

CSS

Result

EDIT ON

LIVE

```
p {  
  font-family: Arial, sans-serif;  
}
```

This is a test paragraph to demonstrate the font-family styling with Arial and sans-serif as a fallback.

Resources1x0.5x0.25xRerun

Example 6.5 Font



There are five CSS generic font families:

- Serif fonts
- Sans-serif fonts
- Monospace fonts
- Cursive fonts

Skip to main content

- Fantasy fonts.

Web-safe fonts are common fonts that are available across all browsers. These fonts should work in most instances and don't require embedding or importing into your HTML document:

- Arial (a sans-serif font)
- Trebuchet (a sans-serif font)
- Verdana (a sans-serif font)
- Times New Roman (a serif font)
- Georgia (a serif font).

It is important to employ font fallback so if the first font you specify is not found, the browser will use the second, and so on.

W3Schools provides an excellent list of available CSS Font Fallbacks.

When selecting and using fonts in your web applications, it is important to consider the best fonts for accessibility. You want all users to be able to use your website.

'Web accessibility means that websites, tools, and technologies are designed and developed so that people with disabilities can use them. More specifically, people can:

- perceive, understand, navigate, and interact with the Web
- contribute to the Web' (W3C Web Accessibility Initiative [WAI], 2022)^{fnref:1a4a91}

The fonts that are the best for web accessibility are:

- Tahoma
- Calibri
- Helvetica
- Arial
- Verdana
- Times New Roman.

Skip to main content

It is also important to use as few fonts as possible. You do not want to use too many fonts on your website because this will create confusion and make your website inaccessible to some users.

Dig deeper

To explore more about accessible fonts, read the article *A Web Designer's Complete Guide to Accessible Fonts* to learn about what makes a font accessible and how you can use these techniques in your design.

You could also check out the OpenDyslexic font, which is designed to help people with dyslexia.

Google Fonts

Google Fonts is a large range of fonts supplied by Google. They come in a range of styles, which include weights (represented by a number) and style (italic) options. Google Fonts need to be embedded into your HTML document so you can use them in your CSS.

Watch *Add custom fonts to your websites using Google fonts - HTML & CSS tutorial* (dcode, 2021) (6:52)^{fnref:1dc22d} to learn how to select font weights as well as how to import Google Fonts into your HTML and CSS documents.



ENTER FULLSCREEN

[Skip to main content](#)

Add Custom Fonts to Your Websites Using Google Fonts - HTML & CSS Tutorial



No transcript available.

Powered by  3PLAYMEDIA



[Skip to main content](#)

Getting familiar with Google Fonts

Explore the font options available with Google Fonts. Choose a font and look at the range of options that come with it. Roboto, for example, is a commonly used font and comes in thin (100) through to black (900) weights.

Select a few styles of font and then:

- Click a font family
- Click 'Get font' (that font family goes into the shopping bag (hover text = View selected families)). It automatically goes to the shopping bag/font families selected screen
- Click 'Get embed code'

Refer to the W3Schools page on How To – Google Fonts (W3Schools, n.d.)^{fnref:3cd3b3} to see examples of how to embed each available Google Font.

Once you're familiar with Google Fonts, move on to the next activity where you'll embed two fonts from Google Fonts into your portfolio.



☒ Typography

Non-Assessed

Status: Done

Reset ↺

[Skip to main content](#)

Question: In this activity, you are going to embed two fonts from Google Fonts. You will embed:

- the font Oswald for the headings
- the font PT Sans Narrow for the body text.

Go to Google Fonts and find the Oswald and PT Sans Narrow fonts. The font weights you want to select for these fonts are:

- Oswald 300
- Oswald 400
- Oswald 700
- PT Sans Narrow 400
- PT Sans Narrow 700.

Embed these fonts into the following code.

Task: Portfolio web application: Typography

Remember that Oswald is for the headings and PT Sans Narrow is for the body.

Now, add the following classes and properties to your style sheet.

For the body text, add:

- font family PT Sans Narrow
- font fallbacks Arial and sans serif
- colour code #46525b
- font weight of 400 px.

For the headers from h1 to h6, add:

- font family Oswald
- font fallbacks Arial and sans serif
- colour code #2b303b.

☐ I have successfully completed this task!



Once you found and selected the Oswald and PT Sans Narrow fonts and the recommended fonts, you would have received a link to be embedded into the <head> section. Your embedded link should look like Task:

Portfolio web application: Typography feedback.

Previous attempts ▼



In the next section, we'll explore the box model, a foundational concept in CSS where every HTML element is represented as a rectangular box made up of content, padding, border and margin.



Thoughts on this page?

